
Leyan Zheng

PhD Candidate in Economics · School of Economics · Zhejiang University

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Education

Zhejiang University · PhD Candidate in Economics

Sep 2024 - Jul 2029

- Major-course average: 86/100; ranked in the top 40% by research evaluation.
- Honour: Outstanding Graduate Student, Zhejiang University.

Zhejiang University · B.A. in Economics

Sep 2020 - Jul 2024

- Major-course GPA: 4.16/5.0.
- Honours: Zhejiang Provincial Government Scholarship; Second-Class Scholarship, Zhejiang University; Outstanding Graduate, Zhejiang University.

Research and Work Experience

Institute for Development Studies, Zhejiang University · Research Assistant

Aug 2024 - Dec 2025

- Compiled and analyzed Chinese population, industrial enterprise, patent, tariff, and trade datasets, including census data, CFPS, migrant population monitoring data, industrial enterprise data, statistical yearbooks, Wind, CSMAR, UN, and World Bank data; measured industry- and region-level productivity and conducted counterfactual simulations.
- Investigated innovation among private firms in the Yangtze River Delta and constructed firm innovation networks.
- Contributed to policy research reports. Reports on accelerating offshore trade and multi-domain cooperation between China and Gulf countries were adopted by the General Office of the State Council; another report was adopted by the Internal Reference and Public Opinion Center of China Media Group.

Party School of the Shaoxing Municipal Committee · Research Assistant

Dec 2023 - Nov 2025

- Monitored public opinion on Weibo, Douyin, Xiaohongshu, and WeChat Official Accounts; used word clouds, LDA, BERT, lexicon-based sentiment analysis, LLMs, and network analysis to write multiple culture and tourism industry reports.

Center for Interdisciplinary Social Sciences, Zhejiang University · Research Assistant

Nov 2021 - Jul 2024

- Assisted with online and offline economics and management experiments, including RCTs, A/B tests, and online experiments; participated in the full process from experiment design and implementation to data analysis.
- Collaborative work received the Outstanding Paper award at the 7th China Behavioral and Experimental Economics Forum.

Selected Activities and Honours

Zhejiang Provincial Challenge Cup Undergraduate Extracurricular Academic and Scientific Competition · Gold Award May 2023

- Second project lead; responsible for questionnaire collection, firm interviews, data analysis, report writing, and presentation of results.

National Undergraduate Innovation and Entrepreneurship Training Program · Project Lead May 2023 - May 2024

- First project lead and author of 'Risk Trade-offs and Collective Efficiency in Coordination Games: An Experimental Study'; project evaluation: Excellent; research report received Second Prize at the Zhejiang University School of Economics research report competition.

Student Reporter Group, Zhejiang University Media Center · News Anchor Oct 2020 - Jul 2024

- Wrote and presented programs including News Briefing, Zijin Express, and Viewpoint; participated in news interviews and special-program production. Awards include Second Prize in the Zhejiang University Mandarin Competition and Third Prize in the University History Speech Competition; work evaluation: Excellent.

Zhejiang University Student Union · Department of Arts and Sports Oct 2020 - Jul 2022

- Organized events including the Hulu Music Festival and the Qiushi Cup Debate Competition as a host and organizer.

Skills

English ·

- CET-6: 590; IELTS: 7.5.

Programming and Data Analysis ·

- Proficient in Python, R, Matlab, and Stata. Experienced with requests and selenium for data collection; PyTorch for training machine-learning models including KNN, Random Forest, and MLP; and LLM APIs for batch data processing.
- Familiar with causal inference methods based on counterfactual frameworks; experienced in collecting, cleaning, and analyzing structured, unstructured, and network data.

Mathematics ·

- Coursework includes mathematical analysis, linear algebra, probability theory, mathematical statistics, stochastic processes, ordinary and partial differential equations, and convex optimization.